



Spring

In spring, deciduous trees produce new leaves. The leaves start their lives curled up inside buds, which expand quickly. The trees can then begin making food.



Summer

During summer, the leaves grow darker and tougher to keep hungry leaf-eating insects at bay. Some trees grow another set of leaves to replace those that have been eaten.



Fall

A substance called chlorophyll makes leaves green. Before their leaves fall, trees break down their chlorophyll and the leaves may become red or yellow before finally turning brown.



Winter

The trees become dormant, which means they rest until spring, so their leaves are not needed to make food. During winter the branches are bare. New leaves will grow in spring and the cycle starts again.